

N03 REFINED INGREDIENTS | O (MAX : 2 PT)

Intent : Help individuals avoid highly processed foods and refined ingredients.

Summary : This WELL feature requires adequately limiting sugar and refined grains in all foods and beverages.

Issue : Poor diets, characterized by highly processed foods with added sugars, refined grains and *trans* fats, are the second-leading risk factor for mortality and morbidity globally, accounting for 8% of all deaths and contributing to an estimated 9.6% of the global burden of disease.¹ Sugar consumption, especially added sugar, has been associated with poor diet quality, an increased risk of heart disease, obesity and tooth decay.²⁻⁴ Refining grains removes most of their vitamins, minerals and dietary fiber. Dietary fiber has been linked to a lower risk of heart disease, stroke, hypertension, diabetes and obesity and is associated with improved digestive health.⁵

Solutions : Increasing access to healthier food items includes increasing the availability of healthier alternatives, as well as limiting the availability of highly processed foods. Based on recommendations by the World Health Organization (WHO), on average, adults should consume no more than 25 grams of added sugar per day.² Limiting intake of sugar-sweetened beverages and sugary foods can help individuals meet the WHO sugar recommendations and reduce their daily sugar intake. Promoting the consumption of whole grains by increasing whole grain options can also help individuals increase their intake of dietary fiber.^{4,6}

PART 1 LIMIT TOTAL SUGARS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

Foods and beverages are sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis and meet the following requirements:

- a. Beverages do not contain more than 25 g of sugar per container or serving.²
- b. At least 25% of beverages contain no sugar per container or serving, or drinking water is available at no cost.
- c. Non-beverage food items (except whole fruit) do not contain more than 25 g of sugar per serving.²

PART 2 PROMOTE WHOLE GRAINS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

Grain-based foods are sold or provided by (or under contract with) the project owner on a daily basis and meet the following requirements:

- a. In at least 50% of grain-based foods (foods that have a grain flour as the first ingredient or that contain $\geq 30\%$ grain ingredients), a whole grain is the first ingredient.⁷
- b. If both whole-grain and refined-grain options are available, whole-grain options do not cost more than their refined-grain counterparts (e.g., brown rice does not cost more than white rice).

Note : Projects must have at least one whole grain option at each food outlet (if grain-based foods are sold or provided) but the 50% calculation may be considered across the entire food service operation (per food category or total number of grain-based foods).

REFERENCES

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7. Food Service Guidelines Federal Working Group. Food Service Guidelines for Federal Facilities. 2017. [Reference](#).